

Tried & tested

\$10,000 for 1 MB

In 1956, an IBM team led by Rey Johnson shipped the first hard drive in a RAMAC 305 system which held 5MB of data using 50 24-inch platters

<http://goo.gl/VTW6l>

Tired of the "Low Disk Space" message. Here's a cool utility to help you visualise your disk usage in a colour coded map

Digital Storehouses

With storage getting cheaper by the day how do you really differentiate between the various offerings? Which HDD or SSD is the best for your needs? We tested over 20 internal storage devices to give you the answers



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“640K is more memory than anyone will ever need.” This is the quote that a lot of people attribute with Microsoft founder Bill Gates. Of course it is a rumour. But how much memory is enough? There's only one answer to that – the more you have, the more you will need. With applications, games, multimedia getting bulkier by the day, there really is no satiation as far as storage goes.

This year's storage comparison has seen some high capacity drives, including 3 tera byte drives for which drive manufacturers have come up with ways to overcome the 2.19 TB limit. Laptop drives have got a shot in the arm with 750 GB storage becoming common. Solid State Drives (SSDs) have become comparatively cheaper, but when compared with traditional hard drives, are still no match when it comes to cost per gigabyte.

We got around 17 hard drives – both desktop and laptop drives along with five

SSDs from brands such as Seagate, Western Digital, Hitachi for hard drives and Kingston, Apacer, ADATA and Transcend for SSDs.

DESKTOP HARD DISKS

Just like an amoeba feeds itself by engulfing particles around it, the various players in the hard disk market are being engulfed by stronger and larger players. Five years back, there were a lot of manufacturers, but then in 2006 Maxtor was acquired by Seagate and this March witnessed Western Digital buying out Hitachi Storage.

This space is now left with only two main competitors: Western Digital (WD) and Seagate.

WD has a demarcation in its desktop drives such as Caviar Black – performance drives and Caviar Green – power saving drives and comparatively slower. Seagate has a similar segmentation in the form of Barracuda XT which are the performance drives and the Barracuda LP which are low power drives.

The big change we saw this year was the introduction of 3TB drives. WD uses an advanced 4K sector, that